



Gaming Headsets

Being audiophiles, it's hard to like gaming headsets simply because a set that's really optimised for pro-gaming is one that, by design, must compromise on the actual quality of the audio in favour of positional accuracy and the clarity of every tone. This has been an interesting year as far as gaming headsets go. We did see some markedly better sets at very reasonable price, well within the reach of most gamers.

Zero1 winner

Steelseries Siberia V2

Last year's winner is still the unrivalled champion of Zero1. The V2 is a set that manages to ably blend a pleasant sound signature with the positional accuracy required of a great gaming headset. It's definitely not the ideal set for music or movies, but it's not bad at either and that should be sufficient for most. It's in games that the V2 really shines, impressing us with its accurate rendition of every source of audio in-game. It's expensive, but offers unmatched performance.

Worthy Mentions

Kingston HyperX Cloud

The HyperX cloud is a brand new gaming headset from Kingston and it surprised us with its overall performance. While the set isn't as accurate as the Siberia V2, it proves itself to be a good all-rounder. This is a set for those who enjoy their games and other multimedia, but would rather not invest in a separate set for both tasks.



◀ GAMING HEADSETS:
**STEELSERIES
SIBERIA V2**
Price: ₹8,000



MINI PCS: ▶
ZOTAC EI750 PLUS
Price: ₹70,000



Mini PCs

Small form factor machines are getting stronger and stronger each year. There are plenty of contenders in the market but some companies are still holding out. ZOTAC is one of the big players in the Indian scene and they have multiple series aimed at different user scenarios. Almost, every manufacturer is squeezing in more components in the same space but for the sake of keeping costs low they've resorted to using one RAM module instead of two with the option of populating the other slot. Also, very few manufacturers are using non-ULT processors. Hopefully, the scenario might change throughout next year.



ZOTAC EN760 Plus
Price: ₹62,499



Kingston HyperX Cloud
Price: ₹7,500

Zero1 winner

ZOTAC EI750 Plus

The EI750 Plus is one of the few processors out there to have Intel's Crystall Well processor. The other notable SFF PC with a processor from the same lineup would be the Gigabyte Brix. However, we compared this with the ZOTAC EN760 Plus which has the 4200U processor coupled with an NVIDIA 860M. Needless to say the EN760 was ahead when it came to graphics performance while the EI750 Plus was ahead when looking at CPU compute numbers. At the end of the day we used weighted scores to decide which was the winner and the EI750 Plus took the crown. The Core i7 4770R in the EI750 Plus was the sole reason that pushed it ahead. Had it not come with Iris Pro 5200 we'd have the EN760 Plus here instead.

Worthy Mentions

ZOTAC EN760 Plus

Having discrete graphics is a boon for any SFF PC. Especially, if it aims to cater to gamers. The EN760 Plus has NVIDIA's 860M which is an implementation of the same Maxwell chipset as is in the GTX 750 Ti so gaming performance is leagues ahead of the EI750 Plus but that's about it. **4**